

of Bluetooth pairing bonds, allowing it to build a profile of who one socialises with. This information would be sent to a server that processes data and returns suggestions or reminders.

The new smartphone is being touted as a device that predicts what one will do. *New Scientist* reports that possible applications include reminding you not to drink too much the night before an important presentation.

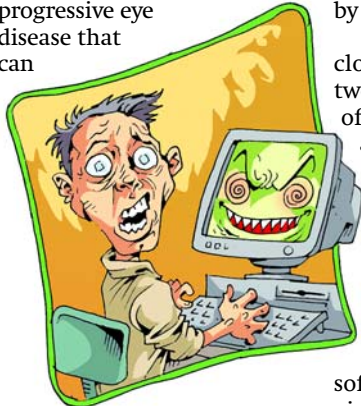
New Scientist reports that the software has been installed on a hundred Nokia 6600 smartphones in a trial involving MIT students. Data is downloaded onto a server at MIT and processed using pattern recognition software. Scientists think that the phone can help students work out how long they have spent partying and working in a week, etc.

Results from the trial could be useful to technologists as well as researchers investigating how social networks build, *New Scientist* reports.

GLAUCOMA RISK

Computers Can Make You Blind

Researchers from Tokyo's Toho Medical School have warned that people who spend long hours in front of the computer screens and have existing eye conditions have the risk of developing glaucoma. Glaucoma is a progressive eye disease that can



lead to blindness.

This dramatic discovery contradicts years of advice which suggested that gazing at computers did not damage the optic nerve.

The results emerged from a study in Japan of 10,000 workers with an average age of 43. It found a statistical link between heavy computer use and eye problems that presage glaucoma. The problems were more common among staff with existing vision defects.

The researchers also found a significant statistical link with heavy computer use among myopic workers. They suggested that the optic nerve in myopic people might have a structural condition that renders it more susceptible to computer stress than non-myopic eyes.

P2P AND PIRACY

MPAA Hopes Parents Will Snoop On Kids

In its latest initiative, the Motion Picture Association of America's hopes that its new software will encourage parents to turn over their file-sharing children to the authorities.

The software, designed to identify potentially copyright-infringing material on a home PC, is part of the MPAA's war on file sharing, and will be released for free by the MPAA.

Last year, the MPAA disclosed they had developed two pieces of spyware; one of which could invade a PC, and then tag and destroy MP3 files. This was not really a threat, because any such software would be criminal, and the MPAA would have had to face a barrage of lawsuits. But by hoping that parents will install the software themselves, thus giving consent, the MPAA

hopes to get round its most pressing problem: it doesn't know who the infringers really are. The goal of the RIAA seems to be this: an anxious parent acting as informer in every home.

SUN'S LATEST OS

Sun Frees Solaris 10

Sun Microsystems launched the latest version of its Solaris OS at its fourth quarter Network Computing event in San Jose, California.

The launch comes after previews by thousands of customers as part of the Sun Software Express for Solaris program, during which, Sun says, more than a half million copies of the product were installed.

Sun CEO Scott McNealy revealed that Solaris 10 represents an investment of 3,000 engineering years and over \$500 million in research and development.

Despite the cost, Sun



plans to make commercial grade Solaris 10 available for SPARC, x86, AMD64 and EM64T systems as a free download by end-January 2005. "Zero cost means zero barriers to entry," explained McNealy. "Revenue will instead be derived from a range of support services."

Jonathan Schwartz, COO of Sun, said there are five operating systems in the market, but only Solaris 10 provided what Sun hopes will be a winning combination of containers, military-grade security, an innovative file system and full support for x86 systems.



What is Longhorn?

Longhorn is slated to be the next release of the Windows operating system. It will have significant improvements over earlier versions. This includes a brand-new and better file system optimised for search, called WinFS; a new communications subsystem inbuilt, which integrates Web services into the OS, called Indigo; and a new graphics architecture, called Avalon.

How will Longhorn be shipped?

It is strongly rumoured that since development on Longhorn has been slow, and since the architecture is modular, WinFS and Avalon might be dropped from the Longhorn release. There has been a lot of speculation in the industry about what will eventually ship. Some have called the stripped-down version "Shorthorn."

Who is developing Longhorn?

Of course, Longhorn, as the successor to Windows XP, is being developed by Microsoft.

Why do we need Longhorn?

Longhorn is touted as Microsoft's best operating system thus far. With all its modules in place, Longhorn will support fast and efficient search, better graphics with Direct3D support, integration with Web services, and more.

When will Longhorn be out?

Microsoft is pushing for a 2006 release of Longhorn.

Where can I find Longhorn?

You can find the Longhorn Alpha release on P2P networks. Obtaining it this way is, however, illegal. There is something called the Longhorn Transformation Pack version 7.0, available from several Web sites including http://www.soft32.com/download_3720.html. The Longhorn Transformation Pack updates XP with the latest Longhorn GUI by adding some themes and patching some system files.